

008. Chapter 2 Verse 20-22

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.20

न जायते म्रियते वा कदाचि
नायं भूत्वा भविता वा न भूयः ।
अजो नित्यः शाश्वतोऽयं पुराणो
न हन्यते हन्यमाने शरीरे ॥ 20 ॥

na jāyate mriyate vā kadāchin
nāyaṁ bhūtvā bhavitā vā na bhūyaḥ
ajo nityaḥ śhāśhvato 'yaṁ purāṇo
na hanyate hanyamāne śharīre

na jāyate—is not born; **mriyate**—dies; **vā**—or; **kadāchit**—at any time; **na**—not; **ayam**—this; **bhūtvā**—having once existed; **bhavitā**—will be; **vā**—or; **na**—not; **bhūyaḥ**—further; **ajaḥ**—unborn; **nityaḥ**—eternal; **śhāśhvataḥ**—immortal; **ayam**—this; **purāṇaḥ**—the ancient; **na hanyate**—is not destroyed; **hanyamāne**—is destroyed; **śharīre**—when the body

Atma is not born, nor does it ever die; after having been it does not cease to be, unborn, eternal, changeless and ancient, it is not killed when the body is destroyed.

VERSE 2.21

DEVAGIAवेदाविनाशिनं नित्यं य एनमजमव्ययम् ।

कथं स पुरुषः पार्थ कं घातयति हन्ति कम् ॥ 21 ॥

vedāvināśhinam nityam ya enam ajam avyayam

katham sa puruṣhaḥ pārtha kaṁ ghātayati hanti kam

veda—knows; **avināśhinam**—imperishable; **nityam**—eternal; **yaḥ**—who; **enam**—this; **ajam**—unborn; **avyayam**—immutable; **katham**—how; **saḥ**—that; **puruṣhaḥ**—person; **pārtha**—Parth; **kaṁ**—whom; **ghātayati**—causes to be killed; **hanti**—kills; **kaṁ**—whom

O Arjuna! He who knows that Atma is birthless, deathless, real, and imperishable, whom can he slay or cause to be slain?

VERSE 2.22

वासांसि जीर्णानि यथा विहाय
नवानि गृह्णाति नरोऽपराणि ।
तथा शरीराणि विहाय जीर्णा
न्यन्यानि संयाति नवानि देही ॥ 22 ॥

vāsānsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya
navāni gṛihṇāti naro 'parāṇi
tathā śharīrāṇi vihāya jīrṇānya
nyāni sanyāti navāni dehī

vāsānsi—garments; jīrṇāni—worn-out; yathā—as; vihāya—sheds; navāni—new; gṛihṇāti—accepts; narah—a person; aparāṇi—others; tathā—likewise; śharīrāṇi—bodies; vihāya—casting off; jirṇāni—worn-out; anyāni—other; sanyāti—enters; navāni—new; dehī—the embodied soul

Just as a man casts off his worn-out clothes and puts on new ones so also the Self throws away its worn-out bodies and takes other fresh bodies.